WONG, Hok Fong

BSc in Computer Science, CUHK; Prev.: Intern, Summer@EPFL

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Academic Interests

Theoretical Computer Science; Big Data & Fast Graph Algorithms; Optimization and Learning Dynamics in Machine Learning

Education

The Chinese University of Hong Kong (CUHK) *Aug 2022 – Jun 2026*

B.Sc. in Computer Science *with* ***First-Class Honors*** **(Specialization: Algorithms and Complexity)**

- **Major GPA: 3.916 / 4.000** | **Cumulative GPA: 3.803 / 4.000** | **151 Units = ~302 ECTS** [Ref] | **[Academic Transcript]**
- **Minors**: ***Mathematics***; ***Earth and Environmental Sciences*** **(Focus: Atmospheric Science)**
- **Engineering Enhancement Program:** ***Engineering Leadership, Innovation, Technology and Entrepreneurship Stream*** **(ELITE Stream)**
- **Relevant Coursework:** Computational Geometry (Postgraduate-Level), Algorithms for Big Data (Postgraduate-Level), Optimization Theory

Publication

[1] H. F. Wong, H.-T. Wai, C.-Y. Yau, "Large Stepsizes Federated Learning on Logistic Regression with Linearly Separable Data: The Case of Heterogeneous Devices," *The 65th IEEE Conference on Decision and Control* (**accepted**), 2026. (**Theory paper: [Link]**.)

Research Experiences

Junior Research Assistant – Department of Earth and Environmental Sciences, CUHK *Sep 2026 – Aug 2027*

- Developing a ***global anthropogenic fugitive dust emission inventory*** by fusing ***multi-source satellite data*** and ***in-situ ground observations*** with AI/ML pipelines, with empirical verifications using numerical model simulations for improvements in radiative budget and air quality forecasting.
- Tackling computational challenges in spatial-temporal granularity alignment, missing data imputation, and out-of-distribution extreme events.
- Work is targeted at *Geoscientific Model Development (GMD)* and NeurIPS 2027 Workshop on *Tackling Climate Change with Machine Learning*.
- **Supervisor**: **Prof. Shixian ZHAI**, Atmospheric Chemistry Modeling and Climate Group, Department of Earth and Environmental Sciences, CUHK. [Link]

Summer Research Fellow – Machine Learning and Optimization Laboratory, Summer@EPFL *Jun 2026 – Aug 2026*

- Selected from 7,000+ global applicants (***1.2% acceptance rate***), with focus on theoretical analysis of machine learning from an optimization viewpoint.
- Derived novel ***high-probability convergence bounds for SGD with linear warm-up*** under (H_0, H_1)-smoothness and the aiming condition, eliminating two major weaknesses of prior state-of-the-art analysis: impractical dependence on the global minimum $f^\star$ and the interpolation requirement. [Slides]
- The refined proof technique combines ***martingale concentration with time-uniform analysis*** of warm-up phase, with insights for deep neural network training. Results target a theory-track submission to **ICML 2027**.
- **Supervisor**: **Prof. Martin JAGGI** and **Dr. El Mahdi CHAYTI**, EPFL.

Research Student – CUHK Undergraduate Summer Research Internship (2024, 2025) *Jun 2024 – May 2026*

- Conducted research in modern optimization methods tailored for ***large-scale machine learning***, focusing on stochastic methods for nonconvex problems.
- Analyzed theoretical properties such as ***convergence guarantees, and complexity bounds*** under smoothness and/or bounded gradient assumptions.
- Awarded ***research grants*** from Faculty of Engineering, with a total amount of ***HKD $28,000***.
- **Supervisor: Prof. Hoi-To WAI** (Network Science and Optimization Group), Department of System Engineering and Engineering Management, CUHK.

Teaching & Mentoring Experiences

Teaching Assistant – Dept. of Earth and Environmental Sciences & Faculty of Science, CUHK *Sep 2026 – May 2027 (Est.)*

- **EESC4550/5550 – Practical Atmospheric Modeling** (Undergraduate and Research Postgraduate) in Fall 2026, involved in course content development (Linux HPC Computing, AI/ML Toolbox for Atmospheric Science), design of assignments and lab exercises (Linux Computing, Modeling Stratospheric Ozone Dynamics, GEOS-Chem, KPP & CESM Tutorials, Application of AI for Atmospheric Science). [Link]
- **AISC5010 – Basic Programming for AI** (Taught Postgraduate), upcoming appointment for Spring 2027.

Curriculum Designer – CUHK & Jockey Club "AI for the Future" Project *Mar 2023 – Dec 2024*

- Spearheaded the ***creation of engaging courseware*** introducing the knowledge of Artificial Intelligence (AI) to thousands of secondary school students.
- Collaborated with professors and post-doctoral researchers to design curriculum content aligned with the ***first AI syllabus launched for junior secondary education in Hong Kong***. [Website]
- Received stipends with a total amount of ***HKD $12,000*** for the technical quality and the education impact of the work conducted.
- **Supervisor**: **Prof. Mei Ling Helen MENG**, **Dr. Xing XING**, Stanley Ho Big Data Decision Analytics Research Centre, CUHK.

Selected Projects

A complete list of projects, essays, and codes are available: [Link]

Theoretical Analysis of Large-Stepsize Gradient Descent on Multinomial Logistic Regression *Fall 2025, Spring 2026*

- ***Graduation thesis challenging conventional smoothness-based convergence limits for large-stepsize Gradient Descent***. [PDF] [Slides]
- Rigorous theoretical analysis of the ***optimization dynamics of multinomial logistic regression with separable data***, delivering its ***first non-asymptotic convergence bound***. Precisely quantified that ***loss and phase transition time scale only logarithmically with the number of classes***.
- Extended analysis to ***FedAvg with large stepsizes and heterogeneous local updates*** where heterogeneity vanished asymptotically. Also characterized convergence on ***non-separable data***: adaptive stepsizes guarantee monotonic $\mathcal{O}(1/t)$ convergence, constant-stepsize cycles exist for $K \geq 3$ classes.

Frequency Estimation in Strict-Turnstile Data Streams with L_1 α-Bounded Deletions *Spring 2026*

- Extended four ***classical streaming algorithms*** (`Misra-Gries`, `SpaceSaving`, `Count-Min Sketch`, `Count-Sketch`) to the strict turnstile model with the L_1 α-bounded deletion property, proving **tighter error bounds that scale with α** ***instead of stream length***. [PDF]
- Conducted ***extensive experiments on Zipfian, uniform, and real-world CAIDA network traces (sliding window and idle timeout streams)***.
- Proposed a novel algorithm, ***Dyadic Count-Min Hierarchy with Adaptive Counter Cache***, a hybrid that ***combines logarithmic space sampling with a small deterministic cache***, preserving counter-based accuracy for the heaviest items while remaining space efficient for large α. [GitHub]

On Quantization-Aware Training Algorithms and Stronger Convergence Guarantees of `ASkewSGD` *Summer 2024, 2025*

- ***Research project*** focused on ***improving theoretical guarantees*** of the `ASkewSGD` algorithm for ***quantizing deep neural networks (DNNs)***.
- Eliminated the need for convexity, Lipschitz continuity and differentiability requirements commonly adopted in prior work via Stochastic Approximation.
- Demonstrated `ASkewSGD`'s superiority over benchmarks (`BinaryConnect`, `ProxQuant`) in tasks such as synthetic data (`TwoMoons`) and image classification (`MNIST`, `CIFAR-10`) with low-bit quantization for resource-efficient DNN deployment. We publicized reproducible experiments on GitHub.

First-Order Methods in Online Learning and Online Convex Optimization *Fall 2024*

- ***Studied and implemented key algorithms*** such as Online Gradient Descent (`OGD`), Follow-the-Regularized-Leader (`FTRL`), and Online Mirror Descent (`OMD`), analyzing their ***regret bounds and convergence behavior under adversarial settings*** with strong convexity and smoothness assumptions.
- Conducted empirical evaluations comparing algorithmic performance across synthetic and real-world datasets, focusing on regret minimization and computational efficiency for ***online learning / online convex optimization***. The project is available on GitHub.

Test Set Generalization Bound in Binary Classification *Fall 2023*

- Reconstructed and analyzed key proofs by John Langford to deepen understanding of ***generalization bounds for binary classification based on merely the empirical risk and size of the training set***, grounded in principles from statistical learning theory.
- Implemented simulations to apply the proposed bounds under given conditions of proposed model performance. The project is available on GitHub.

Selected Academic Awards (by Importance)

CUHK Vice-Chancellor's Scholarships for Excellence – HKD $50,000 *2023*
- One of the only ***8 first-year undergraduate students selected university-wide*** for ***exceptional academic and distinguished extracurricular achievements***, recognizing top-tier students with outstanding potential. [Official Press Release]

Andrew C. Yao Fellowship – HKD $50,000 *2024*
- Awarded to ***only 2 outstanding CSE undergraduates*** annually based on ***academic distinction and exceptional extracurricular achievements***.
- ***Highest distinction in CSE department, named in honor of Professor Andrew Chi-Chih Yao (Turing Award, 2000).*** [Hall of Fame]

Best Project Award - UG Summer Research Internship 2025 (Faculty of Engineering, CUHK) *2025*
- ***Ranked top 10% among all undergraduate summer research projects***, based on originality, analytical rigor, and professional delivery of the project "Revisiting ASkewSGD: New Theoretical Guarantees for Quantization-Aware Deep Neural Network Optimization". [Web Archive]

Hong Kong SAR Government Talent Development Scholarship – HKD $10,000 *2023*
- For the exceptional achievements in the ***innovation, science and technology area (non-academic)***. [Official Description]

ELITE Stream Scholarship – HKD $20,000 *2024, 2026*
- Awarded to students of the Engineering Leadership, Innovation, Technology and Entrepreneurship Stream with ***outstanding performance in recognized engineering-discipline courses with challenging coursework***. [Official Description]

Dr. Stanley Ho Medical Development Foundation Scholarship – HKD $18,000/yr. (renewable) *2022, 2023, 2024, 2025*
- Awarded to CUHK students from Macao with ***excellent academic performance*** (offered by Morningside College, CUHK). [College News]

Dean's List (Faculty of Engineering, CUHK) *2023, 2024, 2025, 2026*
- Awarded to Engineering students with ***excellent academic performance (Top 10%)***.

Competitions

Huawei ICT Competition (Hong Kong Regional, Final Round) - Cloud Track *Nov 2022 – Dec 2022*
- ***Potential Award*** with ***HKD $1,500***, for knowledge and skills related to cloud computing and Huawei's cloud technologies.

International Collegiate Programming Contest (ICPC), Asia Macau Region *May 2021, Apr 2022*
- Awarded ***Outstanding High School Team*** with ***MOP $1,000*** (for both years).

Macao Olympiad in Informatics (MOI) – Gold Medalist (Top 5%) [Link] *2019, 2020, 2021, 2022*

Participant of National Olympiad in Informatics (NOI, China) *2019*

Participant of International Olympiad in Informatics (IOI) [Link] *2021, 2022*
- Designed, implemented, and tested ***efficient algorithms and data structures*** in C++ to solve problems under time and memory constraints with ***strong logical reasoning and programming proficiency***.

Leadership & Extracurriculars

Member - Macao Computer Society *Sep 2020 – Present*
- Served as ***invigilator for Macao Olympiad in Artificial Intelligence (MOAI) in 2026***.
- ***Provided comprehensive training programs*** online and offline for the Macao team at the International Olympiad in Informatics (IOI) at year 2022, 2023. [Selected Session's Slides]
- ***Designed the banner and served as an invigilator for Macao Olympiad in Informatics (MOI) in 2023,*** as a ***member of the organizing committee***. [Banner] [Ceremony]
- ***Proposed 2 original and challenging ICPC-styled competitive programming problems to the Joint-School Invitational Contest*** in 2022, designed to test algorithmic thinking and problem-solving skills among secondary school participants, fostering a sense of community and healthy competition.
  - **Problem 1 (Prime Maze)**: Observations in number theory and search algorithms. [Editorial Available]
  - **Problem 2 (Matchmaker)**: Basic number theory with (advanced) data structure implementations.

Reference: **Mr. Kuo-Meng SUN** (Vice-executive director of MCS).

Vice Chairman and Secretary General - The Macao Association for Competitive Programming *Apr 2026 – Apr 2029 (Est.)*
- Government recognized registered association, with the goal of cultivating students' algorithmic thinking through seminars, invited talks, and contests.
- Co-organized the "HKACE 45th Anniversary Cup – HKOI 2026 Asia Invitational" in the Macao Region with Macao Computer Society in May 2026.
- Official Website: [Link]; Instagram page: [Link].

Participant - Greece Service-Learning Trip (Organized by Morningside College, CUHK) *June 2024*
- Engaged with non-governmental organizations (Doctors of the World, etc.) with the focus on the ***Greek NHS and healthcare access for refugees***.
- Performed ***critical evaluations*** related to ***operation structures of NGOs*** and how ***challenges related to refugees and asylum seekers*** are tackled.
- Authored a ***comprehensive 10,000-word field journal*** and submitted a formal ***evaluation report*** proposing actionable improvements to healthcare delivery and NGO coordination. Related documents are available here and here.
- **Reference**: **Morningside College, CUHK** (College News Highlight).

Secretary - The 12th Morningside College Student Union (Executive Council) *Mar 2023 – Feb 2024*
- Maintained accurate meeting minutes, drafted activity proposals, managed complex logistics, and digitalized organizational records, ensuring transparency and continuity across student-led operations. Led initiatives that fostered ***inclusivity and cross-cultural engagement*** that enhanced the well-being of the College's diverse and international student community.
- Organized events including Graduation Photo Day, Mid-Autumn Festival, Halloween Party, Cultural Fair, Poon-Choi Dinner with strict budget constraints.
- **Reference**: **Morningside College, CUHK** (Event 1 Event 2 Event 3&4 Event 5).

Technical Skills

Language: Cantonese [Native], Mandarin [Native], English [Proficient] (IELTS Academic 7.5, L-9.0 R-8.5 W-6.5 S-6.5, Test date: Jun 2024).
Programming: C, C++, Java, Python{PyTorch, pandas, openpyxl, scikit-learn, Matplotlib, Django}, OCaml, Prolog, JavaScript, HTML, CSS.
Tools: SQL, LaTeX, Git, WandB, Linux, GEOS-Chem, Community Earth System Model (CESM), Kinetic PreProcessor (KPP).
IT Certifications: LPI Linux Essentials 010-160 (Score: 800/800); CCF Assessment of Programming Proficiency Level for Secondary Students – Level 7.
Competitive Programming: Efficient and Optimized Computations, Algorithmic Thinking & Problem-Solving, Pedagogical Skills.

References

- **Prof. Hoi-To WAI**, Dept. of Systems Engineering and Engineering Management, CUHK (Optimization for ML), htwai@se.cuhk.edu.hk
- **Prof. Martin JAGGI**, Machine Learning and Optimization Laboratory, EPFL (Optimization for ML) , martin.jaggi@epfl.ch
- **Prof. Sibo WANG**, Dept. of Systems Engineering and Engineering Management, CUHK (Big Data Algorithms), swang@se.cuhk.edu.hk
- **Prof. Anthony Man-Cho SO**, Dept. of Systems Engineering and Engineering Management, CUHK (Mentor), manchoso@se.cuhk.edu.hk
- **Prof. Shixian ZHAI**, Dept. of Earth and Environmental Sciences, CUHK (ML for Atmospheric Chemistry Modeling), shixianzhai@cuhk.edu.hk

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